

connection with a wireless router if possible, because you'll need it to download applications and interact with other developers on various forums.

Operating system

Linux is a favourite among Web developers and most Web solutions, barring a few, are hosted on some flavour of Linux. So knowledge about Linux is a must for you to find your way around host machines. A good knowledge of the command line (CL) syntax is essential. And familiarity with *awk* and *sed* programming is an added advantage.

Centos and Ubuntu are two of the most popular distributions. The magazine that you are reading regularly distributes the latest versions of these OSs in the accompanying DVDs. You can also visit the website of a particular OS, to download its latest version.

Browse the following to know more:

- The community enterprise operating system - <http://www.centos.org>
- Ubuntu Desktop and Ubuntu Server - <http://www.ubuntu.com>
- An A-Z index of the bash command line for Linux - <http://ss64.com/bash/>
- 'Linux in a Nutshell', 6th Edition, by Ellen Siever, Stephen Figgins, Robert Love, Arnold Robbins, O'Reilly. This is a good desktop reference and should be part of your library.
- 'sed and awk pocket reference', 2nd Edition, by Arnold Robbins, O'Reilly.
- 'Classic Shell Scripting', 6th Edition, by Arnold Robbins, Nelson H F Beebe, O'Reilly

The database

Web 2 applications are much more than plain websites—they provide business functionality and require data and results to be stored. Knowledge of a database is a must for a Web 2 developer. As of writing this article, MySQL is the most popular choice for Web solutions. Postgres is beginning to gain widespread acceptance, while Percona (a MySQL clone) provides replication and other capabilities that are otherwise available only in the commercial offerings of MySQL. You could start with MySQL. A good knowledge of command line MySQL administration and phpMyAdmin is a must, not to mention a sound knowledge of writing SQL queries. Knowing database modelling using IDEFIX and being able to refactor the data models is an added advantage.

Browse the following to know more:

- Percona - <http://www.percona.com/>
- Postgres - <http://www.postgresql.org/>
- phpMyAdmin - <http://www.phpmyadmin.net>
- MySQL Developer Zone - <http://dev.mysql.com/>

- MySQL in a Nutshell, 6th Edition, by Russell J.T. Dyer, O'Reilly

Scripting

Knowledge of server side scripting is what distinguishes a Web 2 developer. Expertise in either PHP, Python, Ruby or Perl is a must. Though the relative advantages of each of them are debatable, there are several people who have started out with PHP. You might want to consider PHP before you move to other scripting languages. In addition to learning the syntax, a good grasp of the coding and naming conventions of the scripting language are a must for others to understand your code and help you when you seek their assistance.

Client side scripting using ECMA Script (or JavaScript, as it is popularly known) is essential to provide visual appeal to your applications. AJAX style scripting is something that you should learn, in order to make your pages truly interactive.

Browse the following to know more:

- PHP: Hypertext Preprocessor - <http://www.php.net/>
- Python programming language - <http://www.python.org/>
- Perl programming language - <http://www.perl.org/>
- Ruby, a programmer's best friend - <https://www.ruby-lang.org/en/>
- 'Programming PHP', 3rd Edition, by Kevin Tatroe, Peter MacIntyre and Rasmus Lerdorf, O'Reilly
- 'Programming Perl', 4th Edition, by Tom Christiansen, Brian D Foy, Larry Wall and Jon Orwant, O'Reilly
- 'Programming Python', 4th Edition, by Mark Lutz, O'Reilly
- 'The Ruby Programming Language', 1st Edition, by David Flanagan and Yukihiro Matsumoto, O'Reilly

Markup and CSS

All content on the Web is rendered by a browser using HTML markup tags. A thorough knowledge of CSS and HTML is a must to bend and tweak your server side scripting to render your content aesthetically and include some fizz! It is an advantage if you are aware of at least one theme engine like PHPtemplate, PHPTAL, Smarty or XTemplate. Knowing the HTML and XML DOM models adds to making your resume stand out.

Browse the following to know more:

- PHP Template Attribute Language - <http://phptal.org/>
- Smarty Template Engine - <http://www.smarty.net/>
- PHP XTemplate - <http://www.phpxtemplate.org/HomePage>
- Cascading Style Sheets - <http://www.w3.org/Style/CSS/>
- SASS – Syntactically Awesome Stylesheets - <http://sass-lang.com/>
- Compass – CSS Authoring Framework - <http://>